

ASHA FOUNDATION — FUND UTILIZATION & RECONCILIATION SUMMARY

Reporting Period: January 2024 – December 2024 (Q1–Q4)

KEY METRICS

Total Approved Budget (BDT): 6,146,000

Total Actual Expense (BDT): 6215500

Overall Variance: 1.13%

Districts Exceeding Budget (Net): 2 of 5 (Dhaka, Rajshahi)

KEY FINDINGS

1. Dhaka shows the most significant budget overrun, with a net variance of +10.18% — more than double the magnitude of any other district. This was driven primarily by consistent overspending in the Training category, which fluctuated between -38% and +38% across the four quarters, indicating unstable quarterly planning rather than a single cost shock.
2. Chattogram shows high category-level volatility despite a near-balanced net variance (-4.54%). Q3 saw widespread underutilization across Staff Salary, Supplies, and Monitoring & Evaluation, followed by a sharp Q4 overspend in the same categories — a pattern consistent with delayed program activity that was compressed into the final quarter.
3. Khulna and Sylhet demonstrated the strongest budget discipline, with net variances of -0.08% and -1.72% respectively, and the highest proportion of "On Track" status flags across all quarters.
4. The single largest individual overspend was recorded in Khulna's Education program, Q1 Staff Salary line (Budget: 71,000 BDT, Actual: 95,500 BDT, +35%) — recommended as a priority item for donor follow-up.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Conduct a targeted review of Dhaka's Training budget-setting process — the swing from -38% to +38% within one year suggests the issue is planning accuracy, not uncontrolled spending.
2. Investigate Chattogram's Q3 program delays to confirm whether the Q4 spending surge reflects catch-up activity or scope creep.
3. Use Khulna and Sylhet's quarterly planning approach as an internal best-practice benchmark for other districts.